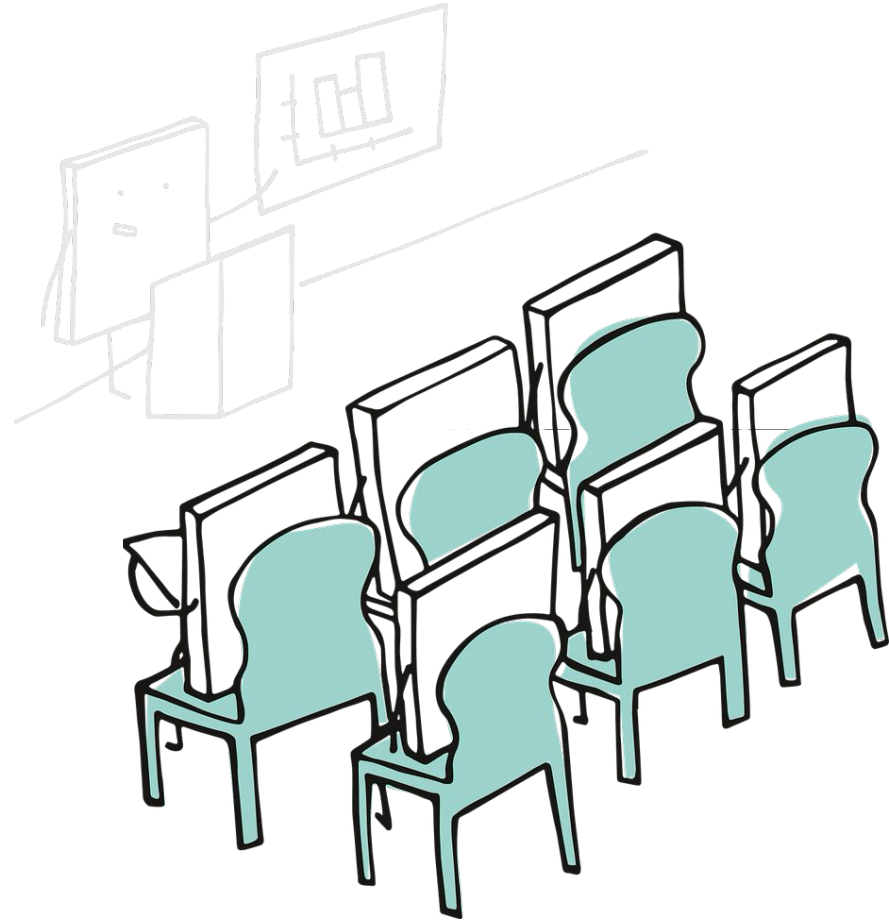


Lesson 10: Target audience assessment

HS192 Introduction to Writing - 2
@ IITGN, 2025-26



Today's learning objective

Analyze audience awareness in persuasion

Target audience for commercials

We watch advertisements and commercials, which are intended to appeal to the respective target consumers.

They aim for “persuasion”.

How can we discover what audience they are reaching to?

Identifying audience

Textual:

- What kind of language and tone is used? (e.g., Formal, informal)

Visual:

- Who is in the image? How are they dressed? What are they doing?
- Where is the image? What's the environment? What is the scenario?

Multimodal

- Is there music? What kind? What other sounds are there?
- What kind of editing is used? Choppy? Smooth? Is it more modern, or more traditional?
- What kinds of shots? Close-ups? In focus?

Source: <https://owl.excelsior.edu/argument-and-critical-thinking/argument-and-audience/>

Read this advert to identify the target audience

- What is she doing?
- What is the scenario?

Topic of Advertisement

Public Safety Message - Don't use the mobile phone while driving



Read this advert to identify the target audience

- Who is in the image?

23 - 35 female

- How is she dressed?

Mehendi on hand,

- What is the context?

At home, kitchen



Read this advert to identify the target audience

Based on the answers to your questions, can the target audience be described in terms of gender, age-group, geography, educational levels, economic status, etc.?

23-35, female, newly married, India, 12th pass-college pass, middle-class or upper middle class



Read this advert to identify the target audience

What are the values the target audience holds dear?

What are the target audience's motivations, either aspirations or problem areas?

Ensuring the **safety** of **family**



Traditional Indian woman in the kitchen, wearing mehendi

Family Safety & Health, Importance of Family Time, Busy Husband



Group Activity 1: Instructions

**** FOR USE BY INSTRUCTOR ONLY ****

Number of participants: 4-5 students

Length of activity: 15 minutes

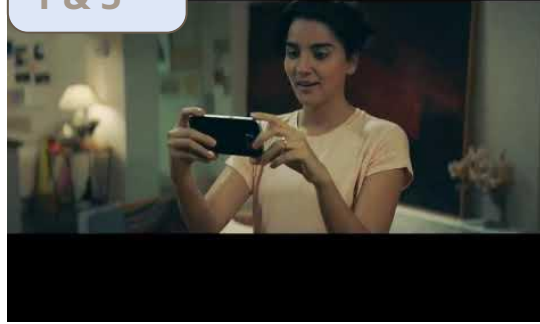
Instructor and TAs move around the classroom, pop in and out of different groups.

Group activity

In your groups, watch this video once. Then, read the questions in the table in the next slide.

Answer the questions.
Be prepared to explain your group's assessment

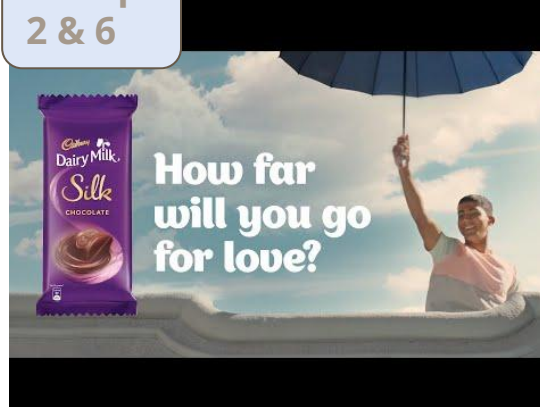
Group
1 & 5



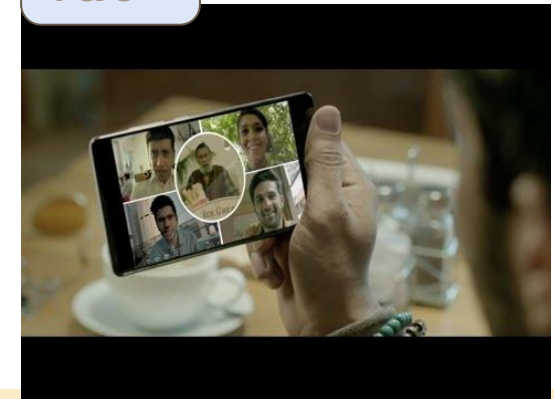
Group
3 & 7



Group
2 & 6



Group
4 & 8





Group 1 & 5



Group 2 & 6



Group 3 & 7



Group 4 & 8

Topic of Advertisement	
-------------------------------	--

Answer these questions to define the target audience			
---	--	--	--

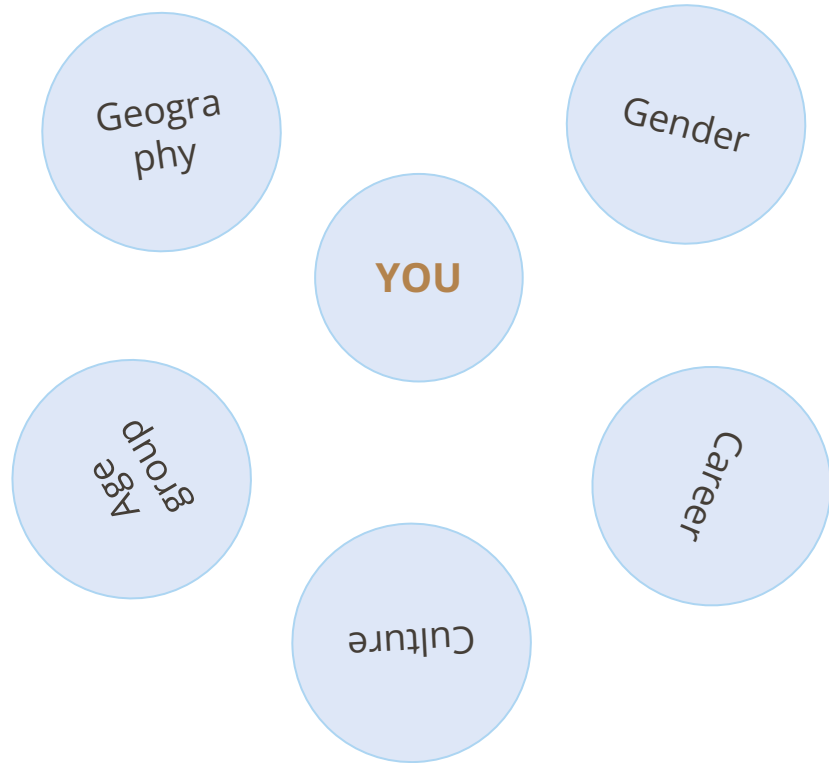
Describe in detail: Who is in the ad? Where is it located?	Describe in detail: Music? Dialogue– vocabulary, tone? What kinds of shots?	What are the target audience's problems or aspirations in relation to the topic?	Based on your answers, can you describe who the target audience is: - Gender - Age-group - Geographical identity - Edu level, economic status, religion, etc.

Debrief

When identifying the target audience in the advertisements, what was confusing?

Share your top tips for identifying the target audience.

Demographics and identity



Write down your:

Top 3 music choices

Top 3 movie/series choices

Top 3 YouTube channel choices

Top 3 book choices

Let's make a guess and talk about it

Guess which are the top TV shows in this class.

What about top music choices?

Books?

YouTube channels?

Was your audience assessment accurate?

Why did so many people think that TV show would be popular?

And, what does it tell us about them as an audience?

Assessing an audience

Who is your audience?

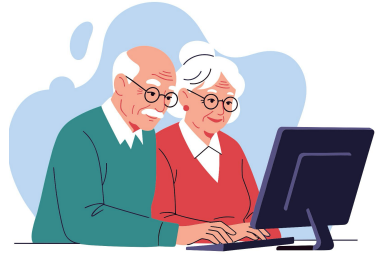
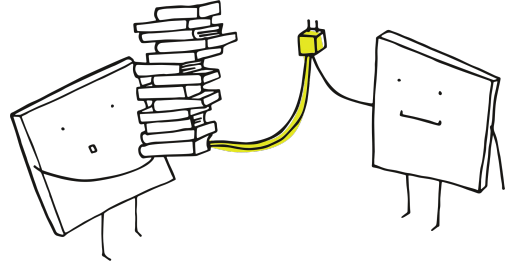
- What that audience knows about your topic or issue?
- What biases or opinions that audience may already have?
- What concerns does your audience face?
- What values does your audience have?

Let's practice

Consider the following audience:

- Young (25 years), college-educated, urban, career-focused
- Elderly (70 years), retired, suburban

What biases or opinions might this audience have? What concerns does this audience face? What values does this audience have?

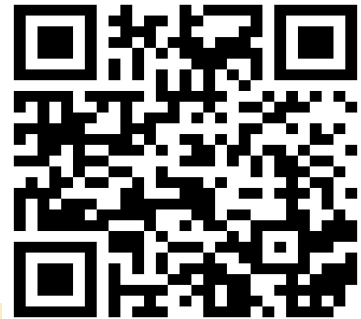


Group activity

Look at the same advertisement you saw earlier.

On the following slide, you will find a description of two different audiences. Brainstorm with your group: what could you change in the advertisement for each of the audiences?

Each group should be prepared to explain their choices.



Topic of Advertise ment	Persuading the target audience to consume the advertised product
Target Audience 1	Students in a prestigious institution, English-speaking, between 18-24 years of age
Write down ideas on how the ad would need to change	Here are a few questions that can help: - What values are the target audience likely have? - What problems might they have currently? - What may they already had known about the topic?

Topic of Advertise ment	Persuading the target audience to consume the advertised product
Target Audience 2	Elderly members of society/family, approx 60-70 years, mostly retired, semi-urban Indians
Write down ideas on how the ad would need to change	Here are a few questions that can help: - What values are the target audience likely have? - What problems does they have currently? - What may they already had known about the topic?

Debrief

When the target audience shifted, how much did it impact the concept of the advertisement?

What single change could you have made to address a different audience?